



GRADUATE DIPLOMA IN MANAGEMENT

December 2025

GDM 605: Research Methods for Managers

(Batch 85)

Assessment Brief

Qualification	ATHE Level 6 Graduate Diploma In Management
Assignment Title	Research Methods for Managers
Module Leader	Harshini De Silva <i>MSc</i>
Issued Date	13 December 2025
Submission Date & Time	22 February 2026 - Before 10.00 a.m.

Learning Outcomes

By the end of this unit, a student will be able to:

- LO1:** Formulate research aims and objectives to solve business and managerial problems
- LO2:** Conduct a literature review to present a research proposal for solving business and managerial problems
- LO3:** Understand a variety of research designs and methods appropriate for business and management research
- LO4:** Understand reliability and validity in both quantitative and qualitative research methods in the context of business and management problem solving

Overview of the Assessment

The module (unit) consists of four learning outcomes and this assessment is set to achieve all learning outcomes. Learners are encouraged to choose a research topic in consultation with the Research Supervisor.

Task: Submission of Research Proposal

1. Define your research problem, objectives and research questions.
2. Provide a literature review giving the background and conceptualisation of your proposed area of study.
3. Consider and define your research methodology and research process. Demonstrate the understanding of the limitations of the methods chosen and ethical issues that might arise.
4. Discuss the reliability and the validity of the chosen method in problem solving.

Project Proposal Guidelines

The following guidelines may be adopted to present the research proposal.

Title	Make this brief and ensure it gives an indication of the main title of your project.
Table of Contents	All the required headings and sub-headings make it easy for a reader.
Introduction (1000 words)	You may provide the problem statements and the project objectives. It may be expressed in terms of specific questions you want to answer.
Literature Review (2500 words)	Describe your theoretical framework and present an initial review of some of the literature relating to your project.

Methodology (1000 words)	You should explain how you will investigate your chosen topic. Outline your proposed research methods and sampling approach. Justify your reasons for these approaches and include evidence of reading and reference on research methods.
Pilot Test (500 words)	Check the reliability and the validity of the findings
References	Provide the full list of source references in the proposal, according to Harvard Referencing Style.
Appendix	Include the questionnaire and time plan for completing your project

Project Supervisor

Each learner is allocated a designated Project Supervisor. You are required to meet the Supervisor regularly with a prior appointment within the course of writing your proposal and the Project. Meeting minutes shall be annexed with the proposal.

Learning Outcomes and Assessment Criteria

Learning Outcomes	Pass	Merit	Distinction
1. Formulate research aims and objectives to solve business and managerial problems	1.1 Analyse a range of different research phases and approaches to inform research aims and objectives at managerial levels 1.2 Construct a research question, aims and objectives to address specific business or managerial challenges in chosen business context	1M1 Devise appropriate research aims and objectives that consider strong research ethics, and measure reliability and validity of the research approach	1D1 Analyse appropriate research approaches, that will inform a review of current literature to produce a research proposal
2. Conduct a literature review to present a research proposal for solving business and managerial problems	2.1 Carry out research using relevant sources of information and literature for a particular business problem or challenge, that can inform a research proposal	2M1 Present a research proposal using appropriate literature review techniques to justify research problem	
3. Understand a variety of research designs and methods appropriate for business and management research	3.1 Evaluate different approaches to research design and the associated data collection methods that could be used to investigate a specific business problem 3.2 Justify a research analysis approach suitable for gathering information to inform a specific business problem	3M1 Appraise research data design and collection to identify the most appropriate approach to data analysis for a given business problem	3D1 Evaluate an extensive range of research design approaches and methods, to argue for and justify a suitable research proposal
4. Understand a variety of research designs and methods appropriate for business and management research	4.1 Assess the main issues of reliability and validity within quantitative and qualitative research, applied in the specific context of the selected proposal	4M1 Justify a 'best practice approach' to ensuring reliability and validity of research into a specific business problem, in a given business context	

Submission Guidelines

You shall submit a soft copy to your Microsoft Teams account. Proof of submission must be attached in the appendix section.

- Word Count : 5000 words
- Font : Times New Roman or Arial
- Heading Font Size : 14
- Text Font Size : 12
- Line Space : 1.5
- Paper Size : A4
- Paper Layout : Portrait
- Binding : Spiral Binding
- Book/Spiral Printing : Single Side only
- Review Sheets : Minimum Three (3)

Plagiarism report generated from BMS approved software to be attached.

Plagiarism

Plagiarism is treated as a serious academic offence. Any act of plagiarism will be dealt with in terms of BMS regulations. Plagiarism is presenting someone's work as your own. It includes copying information directly from the web or books without referencing or paraphrasing the material, submitting joint coursework as an individual effort and copying another student's coursework.

~End of Paper~

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